

ACTIVITY 8

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES:

Canada and World Issues

GC1.01, HEV.01, HE1.03

TASK:

Students return to the values they identified on the first day and identify actions that they can take in an effort to promote sustainability.

EXPECTATIONS:

The student will:

- Identify approaches relating to the protection and sustainability of the planet's life-support systems.
- Identify the complex nature of the earth's natural systems
- Understand the interdependence of the earth and the natural environment.

TIMEFRAME:

20 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

Thinking / Inquiry

Communication

Application / Making Connections

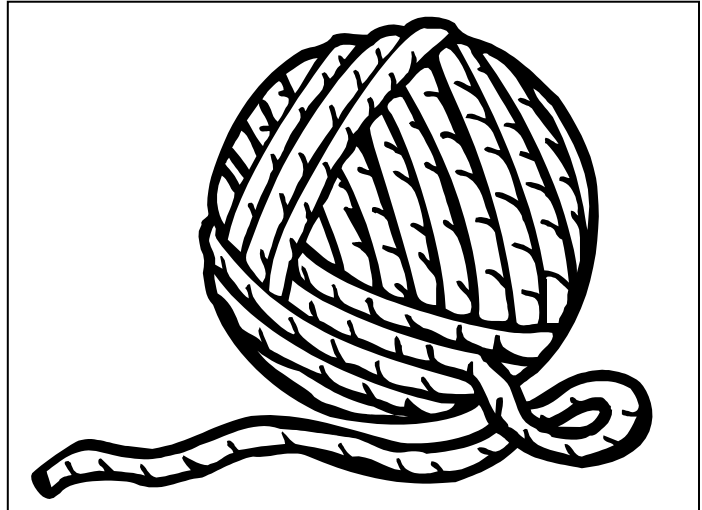
MATERIALS:

Ball of yarn

VOCABULARY:

Interdependence

Ecosystems



Yarn of Life

PROCEDURE

1. Students return to the piece of paper on which they wrote down what they valued most about the earth. After examining the threats associated with their value, students identify one action they can take to reduce the threat that affects what they value most about the earth.
2. Have the class stand in a circle.
3. The first person with the ball of yarn holds one end of the yarn and throws the ball to someone else.
4. While holding the ball, they repeat their value about the earth and what threatens its sustainability. Then students identify the action they will commit to help preserve their value.
5. (Example: I value clean air; Emissions from vehicles and factories are a threat to clean air. I will take public transport to get to school instead of driving my car.)

At the end, there will be a web that symbolizes life that is earth and that all of the natural environment is interconnected. Explain to your students that the web is much stronger when efforts are made to sustain resources (student's values). Students are more likely to take action to preserve something when it is recognized as something they value.

Have the students discuss some of the connections between their values and how they interact. For example, if one student values the sun and one water, they may identify that the sun heats the surface of the water so the various water species can survive.¹⁰

¹⁰ Adapted from Ten Days for Global Justice 2000-01 Education and Action Guide.